

अथ अष्टमोऽध्यायः ॥

ऋषिरुवाच ॥ १ ॥

चण्डे च निहते दैत्ये मुण्डे च विनिपातिते ।

बहुलेषु च सैन्येषु क्षयितेष्वसुरेश्वरः ॥ २ ॥

ततः क्रोपपराधीनचेताः शुम्भः प्रतापवान् ।

उद्योगं सर्वसैन्यानां दैत्यानामादिदेश ह ॥ ३ ॥

अद्य सर्वबलैर्दैत्याः षडशीतिरुदायुधाः ।

कम्बूनां चतुरशीतिर्निर्यान्तु स्वबलैर्वृताः ॥ ४ ॥

1-3. The Rṣi said : After the daitya Caṇḍa was slain and Muṇḍa was laid low, and many of the battalions were destroyed, the lord of the asuras, powerful Sumbha, with mind overcome by anger, commanded then the mobilisation of all the daitya hosts :

4. ' Now let the eighty-six asuras—upraising their weapons—with all their forces, and the eighty-four Kambus,¹ surrounded by their own forces, go out.

1. Kambu is a family of asuras.

कोटिवीर्याणि पञ्चाशदसुराणां कुलानि वै ।
 शतं कुलानि धौम्राणां निर्गच्छन्तु समाज्ञया ॥ ५ ॥
 कालका दौर्हृदा मौर्याः कालिकेयास्तथासुराः ।
 युद्धाय सज्जा निर्यान्तु आज्ञया त्वरिता मम ॥ ६ ॥
 इत्याज्ञाप्यासुरपतिः शुम्भो भैरवशासनः ।
 निर्जगाम महासैन्यसहस्रैर्वहुभिर्वृतः ॥ ७ ॥
 आयान्तं चण्डिका दृष्ट्वा तत्सैन्यमतिभीषणम् ।
 ज्यास्वनैः पूरयामास धरणीगगनान्तरम् ॥ ८ ॥

5. 'Let the fifty asura families of Koṭivīryas² and the hundred families of Dhaumras³ go forth at my command.

6. 'Let the asuras⁴ Kālakas, Daurhṛdas, the Mauryas and the Kālakeyas hasten at my command and march forth ready for battle.'

7. After issuing these orders, S'umbha, the lord of the asuras and a ferocious ruler, went forth, attended by many thousands of big forces.

8. Seeing that most terrible army coming, Caṇḍikā filled into space between the earth and the sky with the twang of her bow-string.

2, 3. Koṭivīrya and Dhaumra (descendents of Dhaumra) are families of asuras.

4. Kālakas etc. are names of the families of asuras.

ततः सिंहो महानादमतीव कृतवान्नुप ।
 घण्टास्वनेन तान्नादानम्बिका चोपवृंहयत् ॥ ९ ॥
 धनुज्यासिंहघण्टानां नादापूरितदिङ्मुखा ।
 निनादैर्भीषणैः काली जिग्ये विस्तारितानना ॥ १० ॥
 तं निनादमुपश्रुत्य दैत्यसैन्यैश्चतुर्दिशम् ।
 देवी सिंहस्तथा काली सरोवैः परिवारिताः ॥ ११ ॥
 एतस्मिन्नन्तरे भूष त्रिनाशाय सुरद्विषाम् ।
 भवायामरसिंहानामतिवीर्यबलान्विताः ॥ १२ ॥

9. Thereon her lion made an exceedingly loud roar, O King, and Ambikā magnified those roars with the clanging of her bell.

10. Kālī, expanding her mouth wide and filling the quarters with the sound (*hum*) overwhelmed the noises of her bow-string, lion and bell by her terrific roars.

11. On hearing that roar the enraged asura battalions surrounded the lion, the Devī (Caṇḍikā) and Kālī on all the four sides.

12-13. At this moment, O King, in order to annihilate the enemies of devas and for the well-being of the supreme devas, there issued forth, endowed

ब्रह्मेशगुहविष्णूनां तथेन्द्रस्य च शक्तयः ।
शरीरेभ्यो विनिष्क्रम्य तद्रूपैश्चण्डिकां ययुः ॥ १३ ॥

यस्य देवस्य तद्रूपं यथा भूषणवाहनम् ।
तद्वदेव हि तच्छक्तिसुरान्योद्धुमाययौ ॥ १४ ॥

हंसयुक्तविमानाग्रे साक्षसूत्रकमण्डलुः ।
आयाता ब्रह्मणः शक्तिर्ब्रह्माणी साभिधीयते ॥ १५ ॥

with exceeding vigour and strength, S'aktis⁵ from the bodies of Brahmā, S'iva, Guha,⁶ Viṣṇu and Indra, and with the form of those devas went to Caṇḍikā.

14. Whatever was the form of each deva, and whatever his ornaments and vehicle, in that very form his sakti advanced to fight with the asuras.

15. In a heavenly chariot drawn by swans advanced Brahmā's sakti carrying a rosary and a Kamaṇḍalu. She is called Brahmāṇī.

5. Śaktis are the embodied forms of the powers of the respective devas.

6. Kumāra or Kārtikeya.

माहेश्वरी वृषारूढा त्रिशूलवरधारिणी ।

महाहिवलयः प्राप्ता चन्द्ररेखाविभूषणा ॥ १६ ॥

कौमारी शक्तिहस्ता च मयूरस्वराहना ।

योद्धुमभ्याययौ दैत्यानम्बिका गुह्यरूपिणी ॥ १७ ॥

तथैव वैष्णवी शक्तिर्गुरुडोपरि संस्थिता ।

शङ्खचक्रगदाशार्ङ्गखड्गहस्ताभ्युपाययौ ॥ १८ ॥

यज्ञवाराहमतुलं रूपं या बिभ्रतो हरेः ।

शक्तिः साप्याययौ तत्र वाराहीं बिभ्रती तनुम् ॥ १९ ॥

16. Māhesvarī arrived, seated on a bull, holding a fine trident, wearing bracelets of great snakes and adorned with a digit of the moon.

17. Ambikā Kaumārī, in the form of Guha, holding a spear in hand riding on a fine peacock, advanced to attack the asuras.

18. Likewise the S'akti of Viṣṇu came, seated upon Garuḍa, holding conch, club, bow and sword in hand.

19. The S'akti of Hari, who assumed the incomparable form of a sacrificial boar, she also advanced there in a boar-like form.

नारसिंही नृसिंहस्य विभ्रती सदृशं वपुः ।

प्राप्ता तत्र सटाक्षेपक्षिप्तनक्षत्रसंहतिः ॥ २० ॥

वज्रहस्ता तथैवैन्द्री गजराजोपरि स्थिता ।

प्राप्ता सहस्रनयना यथा शक्रस्तथैव सा ॥ २१ ॥

ततः परिवृतस्ताभिरीशानो देवशक्तिभिः ।

हन्यन्तामसुराः शीघ्रं मम प्रीत्याह चण्डिकाम् ॥ २२ ॥

ततो देवीशरीरात्तु विनिष्क्रान्तातिभीषणा ।

चण्डिका शक्तिरत्युग्रा शिवाशतनिनादिनी ॥ २३ ॥

20. Nārasimhī⁷ arrived there, assuming a body like that of a Narasimha, bringing down the constellations by the toss of her mane.

21. Likewise the thousand-eyed Aindrī,⁸ holding a thunderbolt in hand and riding on the lord of elephants arrived just like Śakra (Indra).

22. Then Śiva, surrounded by those śaktis of the devas, said to Caṇḍikā, 'Let the asuras be killed forthwith by you for my gratification'.

23. Thereupon from the body of Devī issued forth the Śakti of Caṇḍikā, most terrific, exceedingly fierce and yelling like a hundred jackals.

7. Śakti of Viṣṇu in his incarnation as Man-Lion.

8. Śakti of Indra, Lord of the Gods.

सा चाह धूम्रजटिलमीशानमपराजिता ।

दूतस्त्वं गच्छ भगवन्पार्श्वं शुम्भनिशुम्भयोः ॥ २४ ॥

ब्रूहि शुम्भं निशुम्भं च दानवावतिगर्वितौ ।

ये चान्ये दानवास्तत्र युद्धाय समुपस्थिताः ॥ २५ ॥

त्रैलोक्यमिन्द्रो लभतां देवाः सन्तु हविर्भुजः ।

यूयं प्रयात पातालं यदि जीवितुमिच्छथ ॥ २६ ॥

बलावलेपादथ चेद्भवन्तो युद्धकाङ्क्षिणः ।

तदागच्छत तृप्यन्तु मच्छिवाः पिशितेन वः ॥ २७ ॥

24. And that invincible (S'akti) told S'iva, of dark coloured matted locks, 'Go, my lord, as ambassador to the presence of S'umbha and Nisumbha.

25. 'Tell the two haughty asuras, S'umbha and Nisumbha, and the other asuras assembled there for battle.

26. 'Let Indra obtain the three worlds and let the devas enjoy the sacrificial oblations. You go to the neither world, if you wish to live.

27. 'But if through pride of strength you are anxious for battle, come on then. Let my jackals be satiated with your flesh'.

यतो नियुक्तो दौत्येन तया देव्या शिवः स्वयम् ।
शिवदूतीति लोकेऽस्मिस्ततः सा ख्यातिमागता ॥२८॥

तेऽपि श्रुत्वा वचो देव्याः शर्वाख्यातं महासुराः ।
अमर्षापूरिता जग्मुर्यतः कात्यायनी स्थिता ॥ २९ ॥

ततः प्रथममेवाग्रे शरशक्त्यष्टिवृष्टिभिः ।
ववर्षुरुद्धतामर्षास्तां देवीममरायः ॥ ३० ॥

सा च तान् प्रहितान् बाणाञ्छूलशक्तिपरश्वधान् ।
चिच्छेद लीलयाभ्यातधनुर्मुक्तैर्महैषुभिः ॥ ३१ ॥

28. Because that Devī appointed S'iva himself as ambassador thenceforth she became renowned in this world as S'iva-dāti.⁹

29. Those great asuras, on their part, hearing the words of the Devī communicated by S'iva, were filled with indignation and went where Kātyāyani¹⁰ stood.

30. Then in the very beginning, the enraged foes of the devas poured in front on the Devī showers of arrows, javelins and spears.

31. And lightly, with the huge arrows shot from her full-drawn bow, she clove those arrows, spears, darts and axes hurled by them.

9. Literally one for whom Śiva is Dūta (ambassador).

10. A name of Caṇḍikā.

तस्याग्रतस्तथा काली शूलपातविदारितान् ।
खट्वाङ्गपोथितांश्चारीन्कुर्वती व्यचरत्तदा ॥ ३२ ॥

कमण्डलुजलाक्षेपहतवीर्यान् हतौजसः ।
ब्रह्माणी चाकरोच्छ्रून्येन येन स्म धावति ॥ ३३ ॥

माहेश्वरी त्रिशूलेन तथा चक्रेण वैष्णवी ।
दैत्याञ्जघान कौमारी तथा शक्त्याऽतिक्रोपना ॥ ३४ ॥

ऐन्द्री कुलिशपातेन शतशो दैत्यदानवाः ।
पेतुर्विदारिताः पृथ्व्यां रुधिरौघप्रवर्षिणः ॥ ३५ ॥

32. Then, in front of him (S'umbha), stalked Kālī, piercing the enemies to pieces with her spear and crushing them with her skull-topped staff.

33. And Brahmanī, wherever she moved, made the enemies bereft of valour and prowess by sprinkling on them the water from her Kamaṇḍalu.

34. The very wrathful Māhesvarī slew the daityas with her trident, and Vaiṣṇavī, with her discus, and Kaumārī, with her javelin.

35. Torn to pieces by the thunderbolt which come down upon them, hurled by Aindrī, daityas and dānavas fell on the earth in hundreds, streams of blood flowing out of them.

तुण्डप्रहारविध्वस्ता दंष्ट्राग्रक्षतवक्षसः ।

वाराहमूर्त्या न्यपतंश्चक्रेण च विदारिताः ॥ ३६ ॥

नखैर्विदारितांश्चान्यान् भक्षयन्ती महासुरान् ।

नारसिंही चचाराजौ नादापूर्णदिगम्बरा ॥ ३७ ॥

चण्डाड्ढासैरसुराः शिवदूत्यभिदूषिताः ।

पेतुः पृथिव्यां पतितांस्तांश्चखादाथ सा तदा ॥ ३८ ॥

इति मातृगणं क्रुद्धं मर्दयन्तं महासुरान् ।

दृष्ट्वाऽभ्युपायैर्विविधैर्नेशुर्देवारिसैनिकाः ॥ ३९ ॥

36. Shattered by the boar-formed goddess (Vārāhi) with blows of her snout, wounded in their chests by the point of her tusk and torn by her discus, (the asuras) fell down.

37. Nārasiṃhī, filling all the quarters and the sky with her roars, roamed about in the battle, devouring other great asuras torn by her claws.

38. Demoralised by the violent laughter of S'iva-dūti, the asuras fell down on the earth; she then devoured them who had fallen down.

39. Seeing the enraged band of Mātṛs crushing the great asuras thus by various means, the troops of the enemies of devas took to their heels.

पलायनपरान्दष्ट्वा दैत्यान्मातृगणार्दितान् ।
योद्धुमभ्याययौ क्रुद्धो रक्तबीजो महासुरः ॥ ४० ॥

रक्तबिन्दुर्यदा भूमौ पतत्यस्य शरीरतः ।
समुत्पतति मेदिन्यां तत्प्रमाणस्तदासुरः ॥ ४१ ॥

युयुधे स गदापाणिरिन्द्रशक्त्या महासुरः ।
ततश्चन्द्रा स्ववज्रेण रक्तबीजमताडयत् ॥ ४२ ॥

कुलिशेनाहतस्याशु बहु सुस्राव शोणितम् ।
समुत्तस्थुस्ततो योधास्तद्रूपास्तत्पराक्रमाः ॥ ४३ ॥

40. Seeing the asuras harassed by the band of Mātr̥s and fleeing, the great asura Raktabīja strode forward to fight in wrath.

41. Whenever from his body there fell to the ground a drop of blood, at that moment rose up from the earth asura of his stature.

42. The great asura fought with Indra's *sakti* with club in his hand; then Aindrī also struck Raktabīja with her thunderbolt.

43. Blood flowed quickly and profusely from him who was wounded by the thunderbolt. From the blood rose up (fresh) combatants of his form and valour.

यावन्तः पतितास्तस्य शरीराद्रक्तविन्दवः ।
 तावन्तः पुरुषा जातास्तद्वीर्यबलविक्रमाः ॥ ४४ ॥
 ते चापि युयुधुस्तत्र पुरुषा रक्तसम्भवाः ।
 समं मातृभिरत्युग्रशस्त्रपातातिभीषणम् ॥ ४५ ॥
 पुनश्च वज्रपातेन क्षतमस्य शिरो यदा ।
 ववाह रक्तं पुरुषास्ततो जाताः सहस्रशः ॥ ४६ ॥
 वैष्णवी समरे चैनं चक्रेणाभिजघान ह ।
 गदया ताडयामास ऐन्द्री तमसुरेश्वरम् ॥ ४७ ॥

44. As many drops of blood fell from his body, so many persons came into being, with his courage, strength and valour.

45. And those persons also sprung up from his blood fought there with the Mātṛs in a more dreadful manner hurling the very formidable weapons.

46. And again when his head was wounded by the fall of her thunder-bolt, his blood flowed and therefrom were born persons in thousands.

47. Vaiṣṇavī struck him with her discus in the battle, Aindrī beat that lord of asuras with her club.

वैष्णवीचक्रभिन्नस्य रुधिरस्रावसम्भवैः ।
सहस्रशो जगद्भासं तत्प्रमाणैर्महासुरैः ॥ ४८ ॥

शक्त्या जघान कौमारी वाराही च तथाऽसिना ।
माहेश्वरी त्रिशूलेन रक्तबीजं महासुरम् ॥ ४९ ॥

स चापि गदया दैत्यः सर्वा एवाहनत् पृथक् ।
मातृः कोपसमाविष्टो रक्तबीजो महासुरः ॥ ५० ॥

तस्याहतस्य बहुधा शक्तिशूलादिभिर्भुवि ।
पपात यो वै रक्तौघस्तेनासञ्छतशोऽसुराः ॥ ५१ ॥

48. The world was pervaded by thousands of great asuras who were of his stature and who rose up from the blood that flowed from him when cloven by the discus of Vaiṣṇavī.

49. Kaumārī struck the great asura Raktabija with her spear, Vārāhī with her sword, and Mahesvari with her trident.

50. And Raktabija, that great asura also, filled with wrath, struck everyone of the Mātṛs severally with his club.

51. From the stream of blood which fell on the earth from him when he received multiple wounds by the spears, darts and other weapons, hundreds of asuras came into being.

तैश्चासुरासृक्सम्भूतैरसुरैः सकलं जगत् ।
व्याप्तमासीत्ततो देवा भयमाजग्मुर्लुत्तमम् ॥ ५२ ॥

तान् विपणान् सुरान् दृष्ट्वा चाण्डिका प्राहसत्चरा ।
उवाच कालीं चामुण्डे विस्तीर्णं वदनं कुरु ॥ ५३ ॥

मच्छस्त्रपातसम्भूतान् रक्तविन्दून् महासुरान् ।
रक्तविन्दोः प्रतीच्छ त्वं वक्त्रेणानेन वेगिता ॥ ५४ ॥

भक्षयन्ती चर रणे तदुत्पन्नान्महासुरान् ।
एवमेष क्षयं दैत्यः क्षीणरक्तो गमिष्यति ॥ ५५ ॥

52. And those asuras that were born from the blood of Raktabīja pervaded the whole world; the devas got intensely alarmed at this.

53-54. Seeing the devas dejected Caṇḍikā laughed and said to Kālī, 'O Cāmundā, open out your mouth wide; with this mouth quickly take in the drops of blood generated by the blow of my weapon and (also) the great asuras born of the drops of blood of Raktabīja.

55. 'Roam about in the battle-field, devouring the great asuras that spring from him. So shall this daitya, with his blood emptied, perish.

भक्ष्यमाणास्त्वया चौघ्रा न चौत्पत्स्यन्ति चापरे ।
इत्युक्त्वा तां ततो देवी शूलेनाभिजघान तम् ॥ ५६ ॥

मुखेन काली जगृहे रक्तबीजस्य शोणितम् ।
ततोऽसात्राजघानाथ गदया तत्र चण्डिकाम् ॥ ५७ ॥

न चास्या वेदनां चक्रे गदापातोऽल्पिकामपि ।
तस्याहतस्य देहात्तु बहु सुस्राव शोणितम् ॥ ५८ ॥

यतस्ततस्तद्वक्त्रेण चामुण्डा सम्प्रतीच्छति ।
मुखे समुद्रता येऽस्या रक्तपातान्महासुराः ॥ ५९ ॥

तांश्चखादाथ चामुण्डा पपौ तस्य च शोणितम् ॥ ६० ॥

56. 'As you go on devouring these, other fierce (asuras) will not be born'. Having enjoined her thus, the Devī next smote him (Raktabīja) with her dart.

57. Then Kālī drank Raktabīja's blood with her mouth. Then he struck Candikā with his club there.

58-60. The blow of his club caused her not even the slightest pain. And from his stricken body wherever blood flowed copiously, there Cāmuṇḍā swallowed it with her mouth. The Cāmuṇḍā devoured those great asuras who sprang up from the flow of blood in her mouth, and drank his (Raktabīja's) blood.

देवी शूलेन वज्रेण बाणैरसिभिर्ऋष्टिभिः ।
जघान रक्तबीजं तं चामुण्डापीतशोणितम् ॥ ६१ ॥

स पपात महीपृष्ठे शस्त्रसङ्घसमाहतः ।
नीरक्तश्च महीपाल रक्तबीजो महासुरः ॥ ६२ ॥

ततस्ते हर्षमतुलमवापुस्त्रिदश नृप ।
तेषां मातृगणो जातो ननर्तासृङ्गदोद्धतः ॥ ६३ ॥

इति श्रीमार्कण्डेयपुराणे सावर्णिके मन्वन्तरे देवीमाहात्म्ये
रक्तबीजवधो नाम अष्टमोऽध्यायः ॥ ८ ॥

61. The Devī (Kausikī) smote Raktabija with her dart, thunderbolt, arrows, swords and spears, when Cāmuṇḍā went on drinking his blood.

62. Stricken with a multitude of weapons and bloodless, the great asura (Raktabija) fell on the ground, O King.

63. Thereupon the devas attained great joy, O, King. The band of Mātṛs who sprang from them danced, being intoxicated with blood.

Here ends the eighth chapter called "The Slaying of Raktabija" of Devī-māhātmya in Mārkaṇḍeya-purāṇa, during the period of Sāvarni, the Manu.